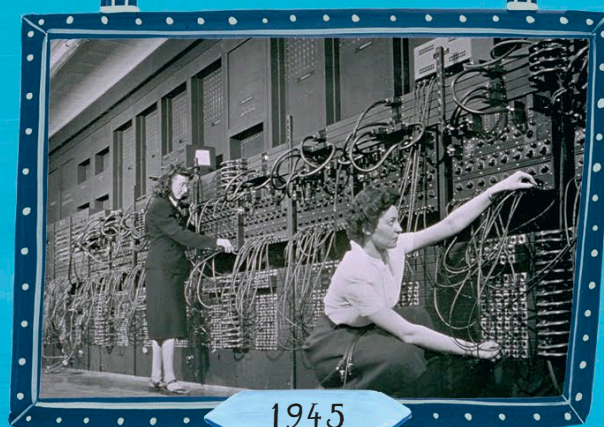
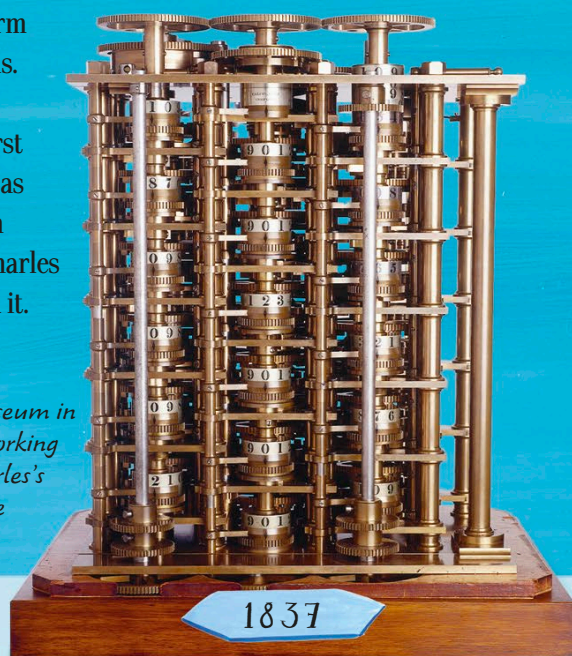


Analytical engine

Around 200 years ago, Charles Babbage made plans for a mechanical device that could perform complicated calculations. This “analytical engine” would have been the first true computer, and it was mechanical, rather than electronic. However, Charles never managed to build it.

In 1991, the Science Museum in London, UK, built this working model of another of Charles’s calculating machines, the Difference Engine No. 2.



ENIAC

In World War II, ENIAC (Electronic Numerical Integrator and Computer) was designed to carry out calculations for cracking enemy codes. It was the first fully electronic computer and calculated 1,000 times faster than mechanical computers.

BUILDING COMPUTERS

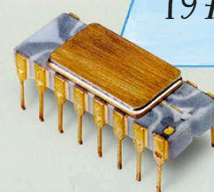
In addition to writing instructions for computers to follow, scientists and engineers also design the parts of a computer that we can touch—known as hardware. The way computers look—and what’s inside—is always changing.



This calculating clock replica is found in the Deutsches Museum, in Germany.

Calculators

Way back in the 1620s, this “calculating clock” was designed to perform boring and complicated calculations so that astronomers didn’t have to! They began with a math problem, then turned the rods and dials to show the answer.



The Intel 4004 microprocessor was about the size of a fingernail!

Processors

A computer’s processor receives and figures out information. It then tells output devices what to do—say, to display the answer to an addition problem. In the 1970s, much smaller “microprocessors” were invented.